

Umbrella

Inspiration

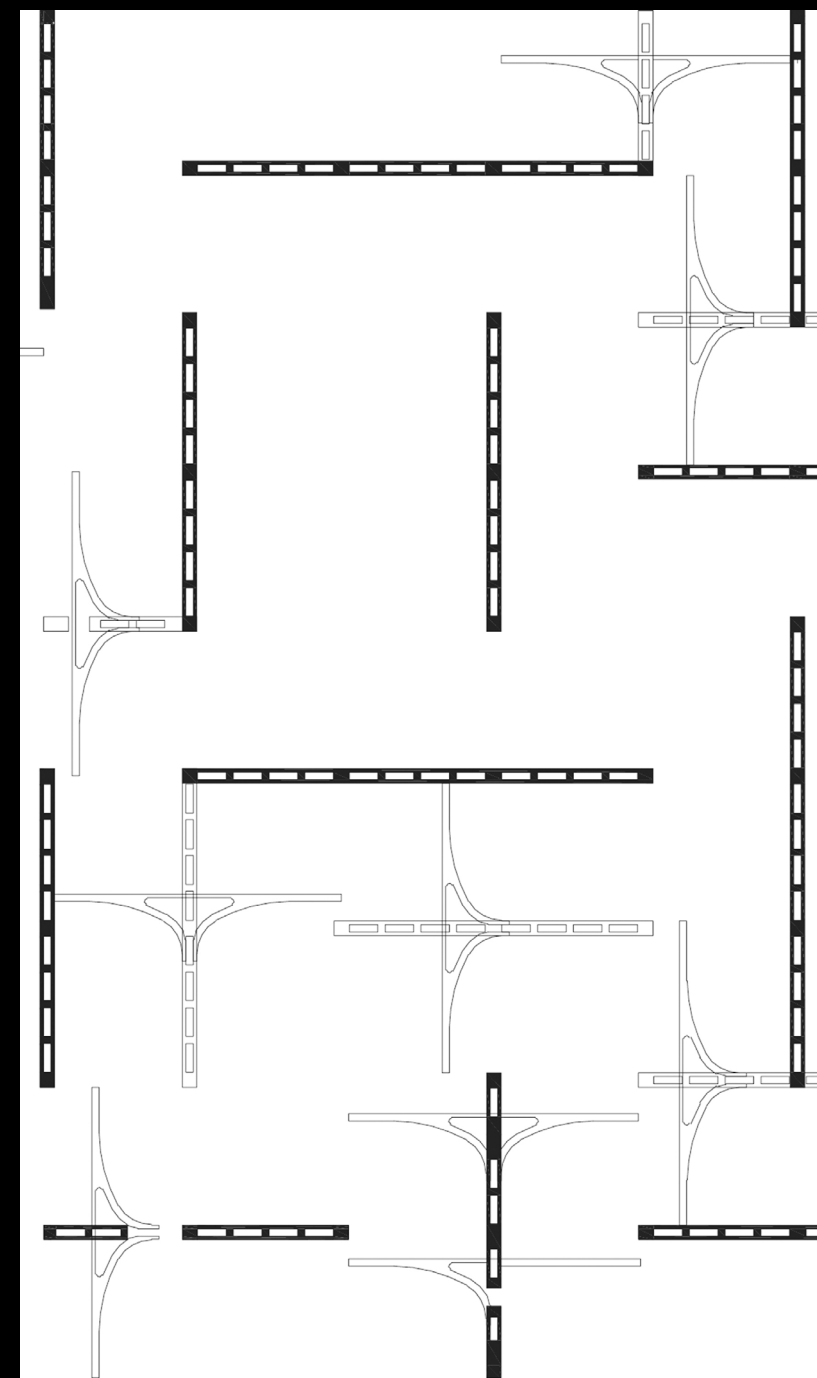
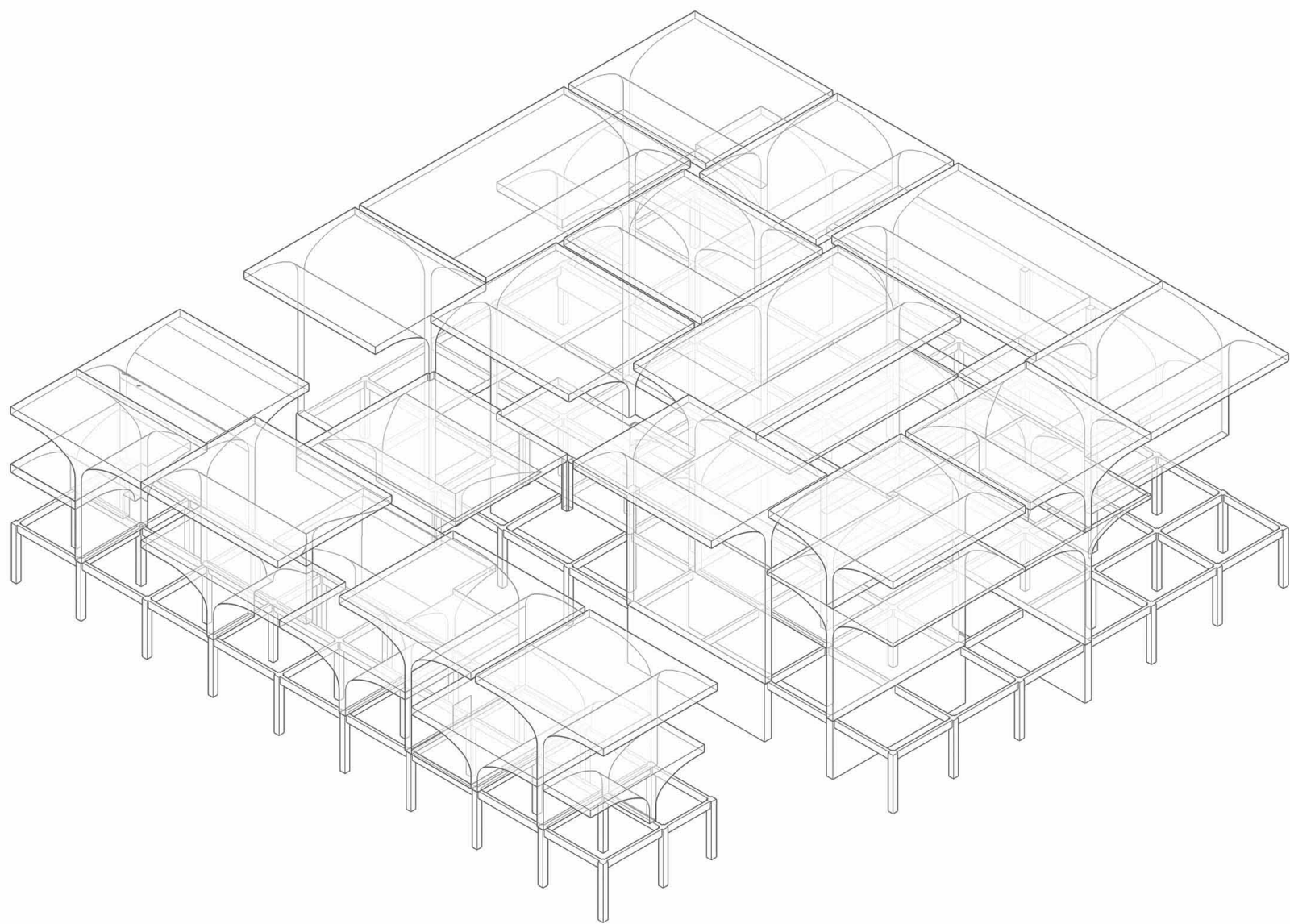
Proposal

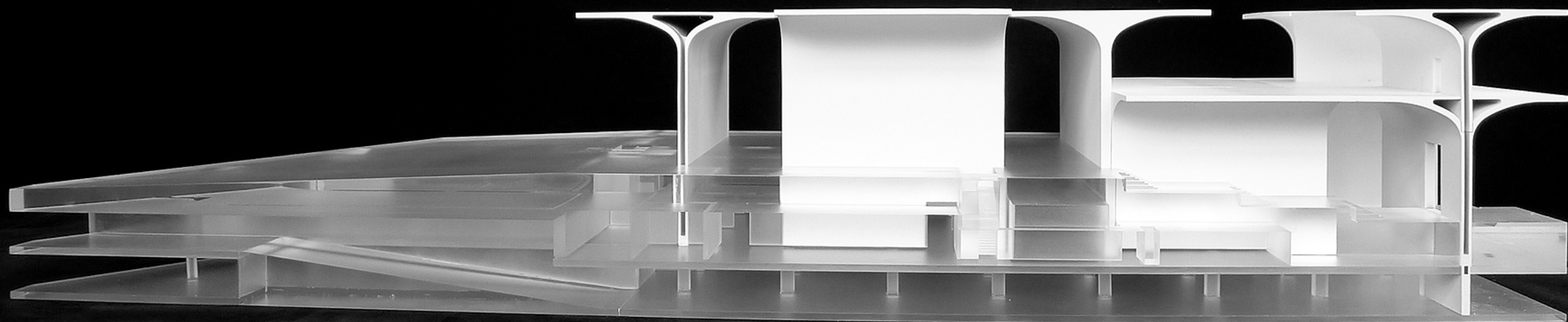
Glyph set

Features

Applications









龍美術館 西岸館
LONG MUSEUM WEST BANK

Inspiration
Proposal
Glyph set
Features
Applications

Umbrella is a display typeface designed for the Long Museum West Bund in Shanghai.

Umbrella serves to be the perfect font for heading, signage and on-wall application for the museum's visual identity system with upright, condensed skeletons emulating the uniquely designed arches prominent in both the exterior and internal construction of the museum.

Umbrella is a bespoke sanserif inspired by the Long Museum located in Shanghai. The typeface is intended to be used as a display font for heading, signage, and large format application that seamlessly integrates into the way-finding system of the museum. The typeface has upright, condensed skeleton and relatively high x-height which ensures readability at large format. The typeface is best for signage at sizes ranging from two-hundred to seven-hundred points, it could be used alone or paired with another less decorative, low contrast, geometric sanserif for signage use, such as Noka hairline or Noka light. Chakra Petch EltraLight could be another option that goes along well.

The idea for Umbrella came from the architectural design of the Long Museum. Being a part of the city's renovation project of the old west bund harbor, the museum was built on an old coal loading station. All facades of the building are made of exposed raw concrete that carries the spirit of modern brutalism. Inside the museum is a complex map of geometric arches extending out of the modular, canopy-shaped columns which is integral to the form of the building. The unique design was identified by architects as the "Vault-Umbrella" structure as each column is in fact a cantilevered structure that functions both as a major supporting structure and a modular system of spaical organization for the museum. Thus the name of the typeface is sourced directly from the term which defines the the museum's fundamental formal elements.

The features of Umbrella beigns with its upright verticals and horizontals connected by tight, smooth geometric curves, which is an homage to the museum's "Vault-Umbrella" structure. It's elegant, high contrast letterfrom implies the contrast between the museum's substantial use of raw concrete and thin tempered glass. The typeface, when put together, feels rigid, hardened, yet with delicate touches. Making it effective at communication and ornamenting a gallery space. As it is perfect for the museum's signage system, it can also be applied as a decorative element integral to the museum's visual identity.

Inspiration

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A B C D E F G H I J K L M

N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

a b c d e f g h i j k l m n o p

q r s t u v w x y z

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Contrast Type: Expansion

Quite Some Contrast

Width: Narrow

San Serif

Straight Stems

Weight: Regular

Application: Wall, Title, Signage



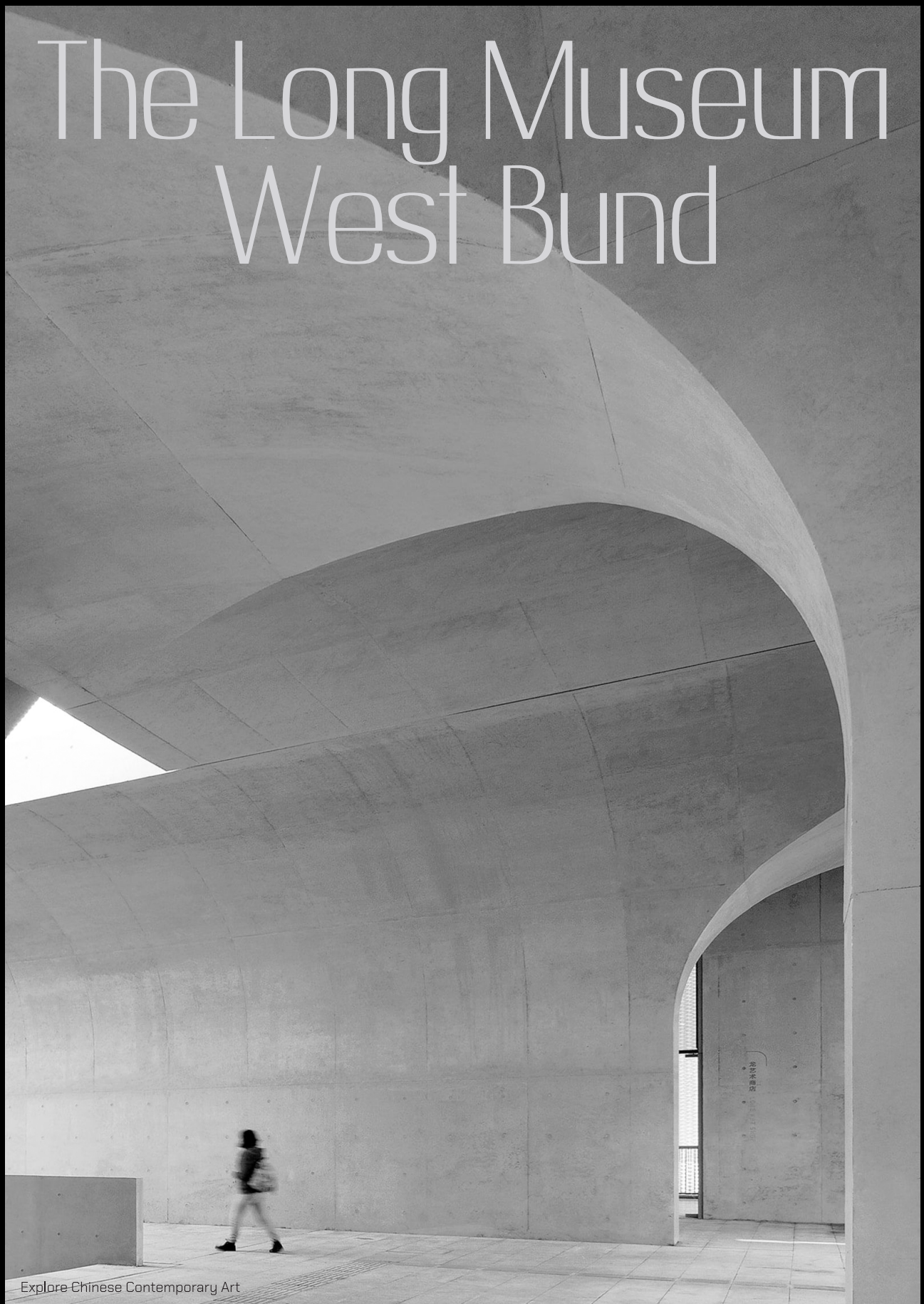




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To Main Gallery





The Long Museum West Bund



Open to the Public for Free
Every Sunday

The Long Museum West Bund

Open to the Public for Free
Every Sunday



Thank You!

James Jin
Lettering for Type-lovers